

Online Appendix

Ethnic Diversity and Cooperation After Disaster: Evidence from Hurricane Harvey

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A1 Descriptive statistics

Table A1 presents descriptive statistics for the full survey file (the pooled 2017 and 2018 waves). Because each survey wave fielded a different subset of questions, per-variable observation counts vary across rows: the pre-Harvey coordination items and the policy-support items were asked in Wave 1 only, the help-received item was asked in Waves 1 and 2, and the ethnic diversity and tract damage measures are merged from administrative sources for every respondent with a valid census-tract identifier. Table A2 restricts the sample to the 1,904 Wave 1 respondents with non-missing ethnic diversity, self-reported damage, and individual covariates—the analytic sample for the pre-Harvey coordination regressions in Table 1. The help-received models in Table 2 pool Waves 1 and 2 (N up to 2,099, reported directly in that table); the remaining Table 2 outcomes and the policy-support models in Table 3 use Wave 1 respondents. The cooperation and helping outcomes that also appear in Table A2 are tabulated there only for the Wave 1 subset and should not be read as descriptives of the post-Harvey analytic samples. The pooled help-received sample has a very similar covariate distribution and is not reproduced separately. Ethnic diversity is based on ACS 2015 five-year tract estimates; tract damage is the continuous share of housing units affected.

Figure A1 plots the distribution of the continuous tract-level damage measure used throughout the observational analyses.

Table A1: Descriptive statistics for all observations.

Variable	Obs	Mean	Std. Dev.	Min	Max
Cooperation and helping outcomes					
Coordinated with immediate family (pre-Harvey)	1995	0.230	0.421	0.00	1.00
Coordinated with extended family (pre-Harvey)	1995	0.278	0.448	0.00	1.00
Coordinated with neighbors (pre-Harvey)	1995	0.127	0.333	0.00	1.00
Coordinated with friends (pre-Harvey)	1995	0.140	0.347	0.00	1.00
Received help after Harvey	2495	0.319	0.466	0.00	1.00
Provided help after Harvey	1998	0.623	0.485	0.00	1.00
Policy support index (0–1)	1993	0.783	0.188	0.00	1.00
Key predictors					
Ethnic diversity (fractionalization index)	2582	0.507	0.156	0.000	0.763
Tract damage share (prop. of housing units)	1469	0.193	0.208	0.000	1.000
Self-reported damage (indicator)	2503	0.602	0.490	0	1
Individual characteristics					
Party identification (1–9)	2503	3.069	2.359	1	9
Race/ethnicity (1–9)	2503	2.191	1.889	1	9
Age category (1–4)	2503	3.089	0.941	1	4
Education (1–9)	2503	4.306	1.709	1	9
Household income (1–9)	2503	4.436	2.710	1	9
Residential characteristics					
Years in town (1–9 brackets)	2446	3.092	2.536	1	9
Homeowner	2423	0.808	0.394	0	1
Insurance coverage	2471	0.579	0.494	0	1
Survey design					
Wave 1 respondent	2503	0.800	0.400	0	1
Survey weight	2503	0.608	0.720	0.001	2.616
Tract-level ACS 2015 five-year estimates					
Median household income (\$10k)	2578	7.38	4.01	0.88	25.00
Share renter-occupied	2580	0.36	0.23	0.01	1.00
Share foreign-born	2582	0.22	0.12	0.00	0.73
Share below poverty line	2580	0.14	0.12	0.00	0.79
Share moved in last year	2582	0.16	0.08	0.00	0.80
Population density (per km ²)	2582	1648.15	1287.08	1.43	24099.97

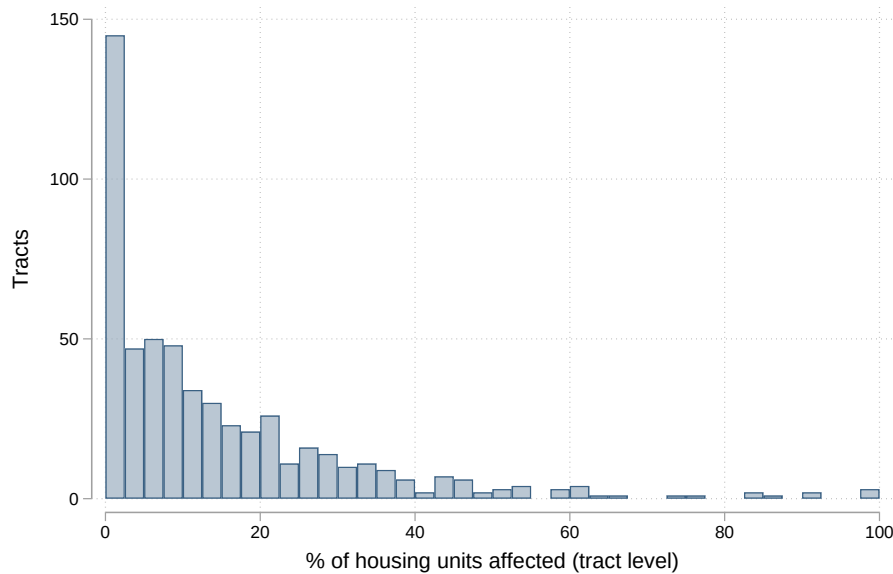
Notes: Ethnic diversity is the fractionalization index constructed from ACS 2015 five-year race estimates (`elf_acs2015`). Tract damage share is the proportion of housing units with recorded damage (City of Houston Open Data); range is 0–1 (1 = all units affected). Tract-level ACS 2015 controls use the five-year estimates merged by census tract GEOID.

Table A2: Descriptive statistics for the Table 1 analytic sample ($N = 1,904$).

Variable	Obs	Mean	Std. Dev.	Min	Max
Cooperation and helping outcomes					
Coordinated with immediate family (pre-Harvey)	1904	0.234	0.423	0.00	1.00
Coordinated with extended family (pre-Harvey)	1904	0.284	0.451	0.00	1.00
Coordinated with neighbors (pre-Harvey)	1904	0.133	0.340	0.00	1.00
Coordinated with friends (pre-Harvey)	1904	0.144	0.352	0.00	1.00
Received help after Harvey	1896	0.329	0.470	0.00	1.00
Provided help after Harvey	1901	0.624	0.485	0.00	1.00
Policy support index (0–1)	1900	0.784	0.188	0.00	1.00
Key predictors					
Ethnic diversity (fractionalization index)	1904	0.509	0.153	0.051	0.760
Tract damage share (prop. of housing units)	1108	0.213	0.215	0.000	1.000
Self-reported damage (indicator)	1904	0.665	0.472	0	1
Individual characteristics					
Party identification (1–9)	1904	3.040	2.368	1	9
Race/ethnicity (1–9)	1904	2.180	1.928	1	9
Age category (1–4)	1904	3.175	0.902	1	4
Education (1–9)	1904	4.337	1.679	1	9
Household income (1–9)	1904	4.465	2.739	1	9
Residential characteristics					
Years in town (1–9 brackets)	1904	3.116	2.578	1	9
Homeowner	1904	0.834	0.373	0	1
Insurance coverage	1904	0.520	0.500	0	1
Survey design					
Wave 1 respondent	1904	1.000	0.000	1	1
Survey weight	1904	0.755	0.740	0.001	2.616
Tract-level ACS 2015 five-year estimates					
Median household income (\$10k)	1904	7.65	4.08	1.41	25.00
Share renter-occupied	1904	0.34	0.22	0.01	1.00
Share foreign-born	1904	0.21	0.12	0.01	0.73
Share below poverty line	1904	0.13	0.11	0.00	0.63
Share moved in last year	1904	0.15	0.08	0.01	0.53
Population density (per km ²)	1904	1614.32	1128.92	5.72	12765.08

Notes: Restricted to the 1,904 Wave 1 respondents with non-missing ethnic diversity, self-reported damage, and individual covariates—the analytic sample for the pre-Harvey coordination regressions (Table 1). Cooperation and helping outcomes (received help, provided help, policy-support index) are tabulated for this same Wave 1 subsample; the help-received regressions in Table 2 use a larger Wave 1 + Wave 2 pooled sample, while the remaining post-Harvey outcomes and the policy-support regressions (Table 3) use Wave 1 respondents, with analytic N s reported in the corresponding result tables. Wave 1 respondent = 1.000 (Table 1 analysis is restricted to the 2017 survey wave).

Figure A1: Distribution of Hurricane Harvey tract-level damage.



Notes: Distribution of the continuous damage measure (percentage of housing units affected) across the 544 census tracts with non-missing damage data; the City of Houston damage records cover only areas within city limits. Source: City of Houston Open Data, tract-level administrative damage counts.

A2 Survey and sampling details

2017 survey wave. The Hobby School of Public Affairs at the University of Houston conducted a baseline telephone survey in November and December 2017 to understand the experiences of people impacted by Hurricane Harvey and to gauge their support for flood prevention policies. A total of 2,002 respondents aged 18 and older and residing in Harris, Fort Bend, Brazoria, and Montgomery counties were interviewed. The survey was conducted by telephone (50 percent landline, 50 percent cell phone) between November 20 and December 20, 2017. The four counties were divided into eight sampling areas based on whether structures in a given area had a high or low probability of significant flooding. Areas in each county that received two or more feet of rainwater between August 26 and 30 were identified as having the greater potential for flooding to residential

and commercial property and used to define the high-risk strata. A sample of active landline and cell phone numbers matched to residential household street addresses was purchased from Marketing Systems Group in Horsham, PA.¹ Interviews were conducted in English and Spanish by Customer Research International of San Marcos, Texas, and sampling was based on the proportion of households in each county and in areas where flooding was expected to have occurred.

Oversampling of areas where flooding was expected to have occurred produced an imbalance in the share of owner- and renter-occupied households in Harris County. We constructed post-stratification weights to address this imbalance and to align the sample with U.S. Census Bureau benchmarks; details of the weight construction are summarized in the “Sample weights” section below. Demographic measures for the combined four-county sample fall within ACS ranges, so no additional adjustment was implemented. Our observational models also include tract-level measures of storm damage, so differences in flood risk are accounted for directly as covariates rather than through additional sampling weights. The margin of error for the full sample of 2,002 respondents is ± 2.2 percentage points; margins of error for subgroups (e.g., by county or race/ethnicity) are larger. These data, merged with tract-level administrative measures of ethnic diversity and storm damage, form the basis of the observational analyses of pre-Harvey coordination, mutual help, and support for recovery policies reported in Tables 1–3 of the main text.

2018 survey wave. A second telephone survey was conducted between June 25 and July 31, 2018 with 1,073 respondents in Brazoria, Fort Bend, Harris, and Montgomery counties. Slightly more than half of these respondents ($N = 572$) had participated in the 2017 wave, while the remaining 501 respondents were drawn from a fresh sample in the same counties. The margin of error for the full 2018 sample is ± 3 percentage points; for the Harris County subsample it is ± 3.4 percentage points, with larger margins of error for smaller subgroups.

¹Street addresses were purchased from Marketing Systems Group in Horsham, PA.

As in 2017, interviews were conducted by telephone (50 percent landline, 50 percent cell phone). The panel component of the sample—those first interviewed in 2017—was drawn from areas expected to have experienced household flooding (areas receiving two or more feet of rainwater between August 26 and 30, 2017). The fresh cross-sectional sample of residential households was randomly selected in each of the four counties. As in 2017, active landline and cell phone numbers matched to residential street addresses were purchased from the same sample vendor, and interviews were administered in English and Spanish by the same field firm, with only one phone number per household selected at each address. Because oversampling of flood-prone areas generated an imbalance in the share of owner- and renter-occupied households in Harris County, survey weights were constructed to align the distribution of tenure and race across Brazoria, Fort Bend, Harris, and Montgomery counties with the 2016 ACS. Together with the 2017 baseline, the 2018 wave extends the panel and supplies additional observations for the pooled analysis of help received in Table 2; the pre-Harvey coordination and policy-support items were asked only in 2017.

2020 survey wave. A third survey wave was fielded online between May 20 and June 23, 2020, using a quota sample of adults (18+) residing in Brazoria, Fort Bend, Harris, and Montgomery counties. In total, 1,065 individuals completed the questionnaire. Data collection was conducted in English and Spanish by Customer Research International (CRI), a survey research firm headquartered in San Marcos, Texas.

Sampling for the 2020 wave relied on demographic quotas for county, age, race, and gender based on 2019 American Community Survey benchmarks. Post-stratification weights were then applied to match the joint distribution of race, sex, age, and party identification in the target population. Under a probability-sampling assumption, a sample of this size corresponds to a margin of error of approximately ± 3 percentage points (± 4 percentage points for the Harris County subsam-

ple); because sampling was quota-based, these figures are approximate. This online wave included the two conjoint experiments analyzed in the main text: the policy conjoint on willingness to support costlier recovery measures and the partner-choice conjoint on cooperation across partisan, religious, racial, gender, and associational identities.

Sample weights. For the observational analyses in Tables 1–3, we use a single survey-weight variable that stacks the wave-specific design weights we constructed for each wave; samples that draw only on Wave 1 respondents therefore use the Wave 1 weights. The weights consist of wave-specific post-stratification adjustments designed to align the survey distribution of demographic and tenure variables with the corresponding ACS five-year estimates for the four-county study area; the precise margins targeted differ by wave (the 2017 weight primarily corrects the tenure imbalance in Harris County induced by flood-area oversampling, while the 2018 and 2020 weights align demographic and tenure margins across the four-county area). We apply these weights as provided in all observational analyses; we do not construct or modify the weight variable. The help-received models in Table 2, which pool Waves 1 and 2, include an indicator for survey wave.

Missing data in Tables 1, 2, and 3. The observational analyses (Tables 1–3) draw on Waves 1 and 2 and use tract-level ethnic diversity; the received-help outcome pools both waves, while the pre-Harvey coordination, remaining post-Harvey cooperation, and policy-support outcomes are Wave 1 items. Wave 3, the 2020 online wave, is used only for the conjoint analyses, where diversity is constructed at the ZIP-code level (matched to ZIP Code Tabulation Areas) because Wave 3 collected ZIP codes rather than street addresses; see Section A6. The ZIP-to-ZCTA match is essentially complete for any ZIP code in the Census ZCTA frame, so missingness in the conjoint sample is driven by item-level non-response rather than geographic matching.

For the Wave 1 + Wave 2 observational frame, the ethnic diversity index has essentially complete coverage of Wave 1 respondents: all 2,002 Wave 1 observations have a non-missing tract-level diversity value. Wave 2 respondents lack tract-level diversity only when their address could not be geocoded to a census tract. The remaining missingness in Tables 1–3 is driven by item-level non-response and a small number of address-geocoding failures. Self-reported damage (`damage_sub`) is complete for the Wave 1 frame (0 missing), because it is constructed entirely from survey items asked of all 2017 respondents. The main source of sample loss for the administrative-damage specifications is tract-level administrative damage (`damage_share`): 837 Wave 1 respondents (41.8%) lack a damage value. The City of Houston compiled these records only within city limits: 141 of these respondents live in Brazoria County, which the records omit, and 696 live in tracts with half or more of their area outside Houston, where the records report zero affected units and we treat damage as missing. Outcome item non-response is minimal—fewer than 10 Wave 1 observations are missing on any of the three main outcomes. Individual covariates (home ownership and insurance) account for most of the remaining exclusions. Table [A3](#) summarizes missingness for each key variable in the full survey file and the Wave 1 frame; the bottom panel reports the analytic sample sizes for each observational table.

Table A3: Missingness summary for key variables.

	Full file ($N = 2724$) N missing (%)	Wave 1 frame ($N = 2002$) N missing (%)
<i>Key predictors</i>		
Diversity	142 (5.2%)	0 (0.0%)
Tract damage share	1255 (46.1%)	837 (41.8%)
Self-reported damage	221 (8.1%)	0 (0.0%)
<i>Outcomes</i>		
Coord. with neighbors (pre-Harvey)	729 (26.8%)	7 (0.3%)
Received help after Harvey	229 (8.4%)	8 (0.4%)
Policy support index	731 (26.8%)	9 (0.4%)
<i>Individual controls with missing values</i>		
Homeowner	301 (11.0%)	75 (3.7%)
Insurance coverage	253 (9.3%)	25 (1.2%)
Years in town	278 (10.2%)	0 (0.0%)
Evacuated	224 (8.2%)	2 (0.1%)
<i>Analytic sample sizes (self-reported damage specification)</i>		
Table 1 (pre-Harvey coordination)	$N = 1904$	
Table 2 (interpersonal help)	$N = 2099$	
Table 3 (policy support)	$N = 1905$	

Notes: “Full file” is the pooled survey file ($N = 2,724$): 2,503 respondents from the 2017 and 2018 waves plus 221 records that contain a census-tract identifier but no survey responses. “Wave 1 frame” is restricted to 2017 respondents ($N = 2,002$). N missing counts observations with a missing value for each variable; the percentage is relative to the corresponding frame. Ethnic diversity (`elf_acs2015`) achieves complete coverage of the Wave 1 frame. Analytic sample sizes in the bottom panel reflect the self-reported damage specification in Tables 1, 2, and 3.

Attrition analysis. Table A4 reports linear probability models (LPMs) predicting whether a respondent is missing from each of the three main analytic samples. Column (1) asks whether Wave 1 respondents are absent from the Table 3 (policy support) sample; column (2) asks whether any respondent in the full survey file (Waves 1 and 2) is absent from the Table 2 (interpersonal help) sample; and column (3) repeats column (1) for the Table 1 (pre-Harvey coordination) sample. Predictors are ethnic diversity, tract-level damage share, and three coarsened demographic indicators (white, above-median income, college-educated).

Diversity does not predict attrition from the Table 2 and Table 1 samples; in the Table 3 sample, respondents in more diverse tracts are less likely to be missing (-0.085 , $p < 0.05$). Respondents in more-damaged tracts are also less likely to be missing: the damage coefficient is negative in all three columns, significant at $p < 0.01$ in the Table 3 sample and at $p < 0.05$ in the Table 1 sample, and not significant in the Table 2 sample. Above-median-income respondents are more likely to be missing in the Table 3 and Table 1 samples ($p < 0.05$), and White respondents are marginally less likely to be missing in the Table 2 sample ($p < 0.10$).

Table A4: Attrition: linear probability models predicting absence from each analytic sample.

	Missing from Table 3	Missing from Table 2	Missing from Table 1
	(1)	(2)	(3)
	Wave 1 frame	Full file	Wave 1 frame
Diversity	-0.085** (0.042)	0.003 (0.057)	-0.049 (0.044)
Tract damage share	-0.069*** (0.025)	-0.065 (0.055)	-0.051** (0.026)
White respondent	-0.021 (0.015)	-0.035* (0.020)	-0.019 (0.015)
Above-median income	0.043** (0.018)	0.022 (0.021)	0.035** (0.017)
College-educated	-0.023 (0.016)	-0.017 (0.021)	-0.003 (0.016)
Observations	886	1014	886
R-squared	0.019	0.006	0.009

Notes: Dependent variable = 1 if respondent is not in the analytic sample. Column (1) and (3): estimated on Wave 1 respondents with non-missing predictors ($N = 886$). Column (2): estimated on all respondents with non-missing predictors ($N = 1,014$). Damage is missing for tracts outside the area the City of Houston records cover, so these models include only respondents with measured damage. Damage share is on a 0–1 scale. Standard errors clustered at census tract. *** $p < 0.01$; ** $p < 0.05$; * $p < 0.1$.

A3 Correlations between ethnic diversity and tract-level controls

More diverse tracts may be lower-income, more transient, or more renter-heavy, so that the diversity coefficient could reflect a bundle of socioeconomic confounds. Table A5 shows that diversity is only modestly correlated with most of these tract characteristics. Ethnic diversity is uncorrelated with median household income ($r = 0.04$), essentially uncorrelated with density ($r = -0.02$) and the foreign-born share ($r = 0.06$), and *negatively* correlated with poverty ($r = -0.26$): the more diverse tracts are *less* poor on average. Adding tract controls to the main regressions barely moves the diversity coefficient.

Table A5: Pairwise correlations between ethnic diversity and tract-level ACS 2015 controls.

Tract characteristic	r with ethnic diversity
Median household income	+0.04
% renter-occupied	+0.06
% foreign-born	+0.06
% below poverty	-0.26
% moved in last year	+0.20
Population density	-0.02
Tract-level damage share	-0.26

Notes: Pairwise Pearson correlations computed at the unique-tract level across the 968 tracts with non-missing diversity; each correlation uses the tracts with non-missing values on both variables (544 for damage share). Ethnic diversity is the fractionalization index from ACS 2015 race estimates (`elf_acs2015`).

The conjoint analyses measure diversity at the ZIP-code level. Table A6 reports the corresponding correlations across the 251 ZIP codes in the Wave 3 policy-conjoint sample. Diversity is weakly positively correlated with income ($r = 0.16$) and negatively with poverty ($r = -0.17$).

Table A6: Pairwise correlations between ethnic diversity and ZIP-code-level ACS 2015 controls.

ZIP-code characteristic	r with ethnic diversity
Median household income	0.16
% renter-occupied	0.18
% foreign-born	0.29
% below poverty	-0.17
% moved in last year	0.23

Notes: Pairwise Pearson correlations across the 251 ZIP codes represented in the Wave 3 policy-conjoint sample. Diversity is the ZIP-code fractionalization index used in the conjoint analyses (ACS 2014–2018 five-year estimates; see Section A6); the covariates are the ZIP-code ACS 2015 controls.

A4 Pre-Harvey coordination: tests across tie types

Table A7 tests whether the diversity coefficients in Table 1 differ across tie types. The four equations are stacked by seemingly unrelated estimation, which accounts for the correlation of estimates across outcomes reported by the same respondents; the joint estimation uses importance weights and clusters standard errors at the census-tract level. Each coefficient is compared with the neighbors coefficient, and the final row tests equality of all four.

Table A7: Diversity coefficients by tie type and cross-equation tests.

Outcome	Point estimate on Diversity		Cross-equation Wald test vs. Neighbors	
	Coefficient	Std. error	χ^2	<i>p</i> -value
Immediate family	0.084	0.130	3.309	0.069
Extended family	-0.079	0.154	0.396	0.529
Neighbors	-0.187	0.113	—	—
Friends	-0.162	0.159	0.032	0.857
Joint: all four equal	—		3.386 (df = 3)	0.336

Notes: Coefficients from the specification of Table 1 with tract controls. χ^2 statistics from Wald tests on the stacked equations.

A5 Additional damage specifications

A5.1 Interpersonal cooperation: magnitudes

Table A8 reports, for each interpersonal-cooperation outcome, the Diversity $\times$ Damage estimate from the continuous-damage specification of Table 2 together with its 95% confidence interval, its translation into percentage points, and the mean of the outcome in the estimation sample. For a resident of a heavily damaged tract, moving from the first to the third quartile of tract diversity changes the probability of having provided help by +4.5 points and of having received help by -8.0 points, neither statistically significant.

Table A8: Interpersonal cooperation: Diversity $\times$ Damage estimates with confidence intervals.

Outcome	Diversity $\times$ Damage	Std. error	95% CI	IQR shift (pp)	Mean of DV	<i>N</i>
Received help	-0.955	0.855	[-2.636, 0.725]	-8.0 [-22.1, 6.1]	0.346	1194
Provided help	0.541	0.955	[-1.337, 2.420]	4.5 [-11.2, 20.3]	0.572	1108
log(1 + volunteers)	-1.230	2.146	[-5.452, 2.991]	—	1.851	857
Cooperation index	-0.684	1.098	[-2.843, 1.476]	-5.7 [-23.9, 12.4]	-0.073	1108

Notes: Continuous-damage specification of Table 2. IQR shift is the coefficient and its confidence interval multiplied by the interquartile range of tract diversity (0.37 to 0.65) and the 75th percentile of tract damage share (0.31), both survey-weighted across respondents in the received-help estimation sample, in percentage points of the outcome; not defined for the log-volunteers outcome. Mean of DV is the survey-weighted mean of the outcome in the estimation sample.

A5.2 Policy support: binned interaction

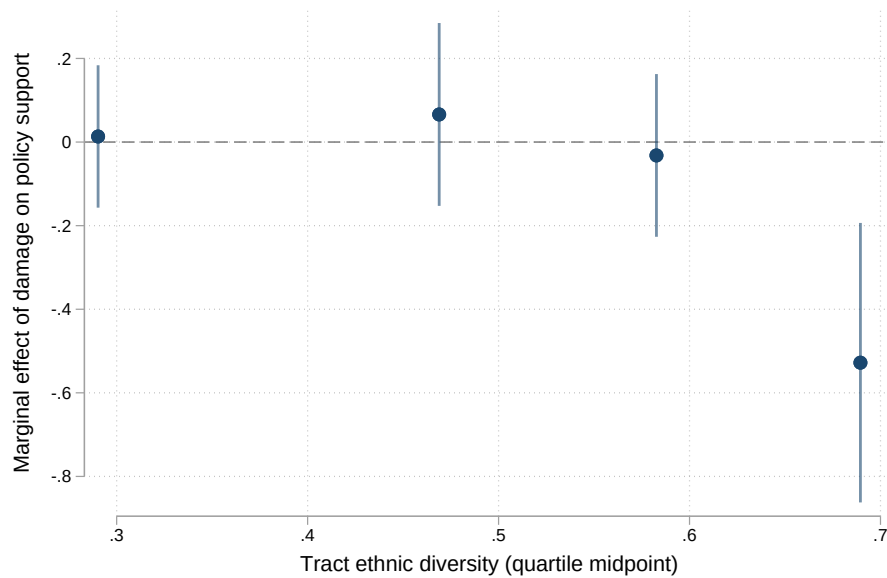
Table A9 and Figure A2 relax the linear interaction in Table 3: diversity is divided into quartiles and the damage slope is estimated separately within each, with the same controls, weights, and clustering. A joint test rejects equality of the four slopes ($F(3, 361) = 3.08, p = 0.028$).

Table A9: Marginal effect of damage on policy support by quartile of tract diversity.

Diversity quartile	ME(damage)	95% CI	Std. error
Q1 (least diverse)	0.013	[-0.16, 0.18]	0.087
Q2	0.066	[-0.15, 0.28]	0.112
Q3	-0.032	[-0.23, 0.16]	0.099
Q4 (most diverse)	-0.528	[-0.86, -0.19]	0.171

Notes: Quartile-specific slopes on tract damage share from the specification of Table 3. Standard errors clustered at the census-tract level.

Figure A2: Marginal effect of damage on policy support by quartile of tract diversity.



Notes: Points are the quartile-specific slopes of Table A9, plotted at the quartile midpoint; bars are 95% confidence intervals.

A5.3 Policy support: individual policy items

Table A10 estimates separate models for each of the ten individual policy proposals that make up the index used in Table 3, under each of the three damage measures used there. Respondents were asked if they supported or opposed the following policies: (1) a program to buy homes in areas that have repeatedly flooded with local, state, and federal moneys, (2) the construction of a new

reservoir to protect the western portion of the Houston area, (3) greater restrictions on construction in flood plains, (4) the establishment of a regional flood agency with taxing authority to plan for the prevention of regional flooding, (5) denying federally financed flood insurance to homeowners whose homes have flooded three or more times since 2001, (6) not allowing homes that have flooded three or more times since 2001 to be rebuilt by buying out these homeowners with local and federal moneys, (7) requiring sellers of homes to fully disclose prior flood damage to their homes and prior flooding in the surrounding neighborhood, (8) preventing development/construction on native prairies and wetlands in western and northwestern portions of Harris County, (9) requiring government compensation for homes that are flooded due to the release of water from local reservoirs, and (10) new building codes that require homes built in flood-prone areas to be elevated/raised to avoid flooding.

The items that reach statistical significance vary with the damage measure. Under self-reported damage, the buyout program (-0.50 , $p < 0.05$) is significant, with restrictions on flood-plain construction at $p < 0.10$; under the continuous damage share, restrictions on flood-plain construction and the denial of federal flood insurance to repeat claimants are significant (both $p < 0.05$), with compensation for reservoir-release flooding at $p < 0.10$; under the above-median indicator, the denial of federal flood insurance and buyouts in place of rebuilding reach $p < 0.10$. Overall, three of the ten policy items are significant at the 5 percent level under at least one damage measure, and five at the 10 percent level. The pattern does not follow the split between spending and regulatory items, which Table 4 in the main text tests directly.

Table A10: Support for individual policies: Diversity $\times$ Damage by damage measure.

Policy item	Self-reported damage (1)	Continuous damage share (2)	Above-median damage (3)
Buyout program for repeatedly flooded homes	-0.497** (0.196)	-0.295 (0.934)	-0.021 (0.352)
New reservoir to protect western Houston	-0.220 (0.139)	-0.128 (0.613)	0.042 (0.187)
Restrictions on flood-plain construction	-0.278* (0.166)	-1.779** (0.723)	-0.134 (0.220)
Regional flood agency with taxing authority	-0.183 (0.204)	0.069 (0.766)	-0.089 (0.288)
Deny federal flood insurance to repeat claimants	-0.155 (0.218)	-2.217** (1.111)	-0.707* (0.361)
Buyouts in place of rebuilding repeatedly flooded homes	-0.078 (0.215)	-1.008 (0.949)	-0.518* (0.313)
Seller disclosure of prior flooding	-0.135 (0.107)	0.305 (0.593)	0.194 (0.169)
No development on prairies and wetlands	-0.004 (0.190)	-0.369 (1.028)	-0.064 (0.324)
Compensation for reservoir-release flooding	-0.241 (0.180)	-1.536* (0.798)	-0.383 (0.241)
Elevation building codes in flood-prone areas	-0.115 (0.133)	0.131 (0.646)	-0.121 (0.204)

Notes: Each cell reports the Diversity $\times$ Damage coefficient from a separate OLS regression of support for the indicated item (0/1) on diversity, damage, and their interaction, under the damage measure in the column header: self-reported damage (binary), the share of housing units affected in the tract (continuous), and an indicator for damage at or above the median among damaged tracts. All specifications include individual controls (party identification, race, age, education, income, evacuation, years in town, home ownership, insurance), six ACS 2015 tract controls, and ZIP-code fixed effects, and are weighted by survey weights; standard errors, in parentheses, are clustered at the census-tract level. N ranges from 963 to 1,833 across cells. *** $p < 0.01$; ** $p < 0.05$; * $p < 0.1$

A5.4 An alternative damage measure: FEMA registrations

The City of Houston damage records cover only areas within city limits. As a check, we construct an alternative tract-level damage measure from FEMA’s Individuals and Households Program registrations for Hurricane Harvey (disaster DR-4332), which cover all four counties. This measure is the share of a tract’s housing units for which the registering household reported home damage. In tracts inside Houston, this measure has a correlation of 0.78 with the City of Houston measure. Tables A11 and A12 re-estimate Tables 2 and 3 using the FEMA measure in place of the City of Houston measure; the self-reported columns are unchanged.

Table A11: Interpersonal cooperation with the FEMA damage measure.

	Received help			Provided help			log(1+Vol. known)			Coop. index		
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)	(11)	(12)
	Self-rep	Continuous	Above med	Self-rep	Continuous	Above med	Self-rep	Continuous	Above med	Self-rep	Continuous	Above med
Diversity	-0.379*	-0.363*	-0.157	0.103	-0.290	-0.174	0.675	-0.873	-0.362	-0.168	-0.715**	-0.355
	(0.214)	(0.199)	(0.190)	(0.258)	(0.224)	(0.211)	(0.655)	(0.646)	(0.612)	(0.377)	(0.320)	(0.307)
Damage	0.116	0.212	0.159	0.152	-1.141***	-0.247*	0.608*	-2.999***	-0.516*	0.286	-1.348***	-0.171
	(0.124)	(0.352)	(0.116)	(0.143)	(0.404)	(0.148)	(0.314)	(0.956)	(0.301)	(0.224)	(0.514)	(0.188)
Diversity × Damage	0.104	0.120	-0.307	-0.081	1.418**	0.372	-0.751	4.214**	0.825	-0.061	2.041**	0.199
	(0.222)	(0.629)	(0.214)	(0.259)	(0.672)	(0.255)	(0.589)	(1.725)	(0.564)	(0.398)	(0.916)	(0.336)
Observations	2099	2099	2099	1906	1906	1906	1470	1470	1470	1905	1905	1905
Adj. R-squared	0.196	0.181	0.177	0.163	0.168	0.158	0.224	0.229	0.220	0.188	0.171	0.167

Notes: Results from OLS models. Each outcome is estimated under three damage measures: self-reported damage (Self-rep), FEMA tract-level damage share (Continuous), and above-median FEMA damage (Above med; median among damaged tracts). *Received help* (cols 1–3) is observed in both the 2017 (Wave 1) and 2018 (Wave 2) survey waves and pooled across them; the remaining three outcomes—*Provided help* (cols 4–6), *log(1+Vol. known)* (cols 7–9), and the cooperation index (cols 10–12)—are 2017 (Wave 1) items only. All specifications include individual controls (party ID, age, education, race, income, evacuation, years in town, home ownership, insurance), ZIP-code fixed effects, and six tract-level controls (median household income, % renter, % foreign-born, population density, % below poverty, % moved in the past year); the received-help specifications (cols 1–3) also include a survey-wave indicator. Survey weights included. Standard errors clustered at the census-tract level. *** $p < 0.01$; ** $p < 0.05$; * $p < 0.1$

Table A12: Support for recovery policies with the FEMA damage measure.

	Support for Policies (Index)		
	(1) Self-reported	(2) Continuous	(3) Above median
Diversity	0.083 (0.084)	0.059 (0.101)	0.104 (0.094)
Damage	0.118*** (0.044)	0.306** (0.154)	0.132** (0.053)
Diversity $\times$ Damage	-0.200** (0.080)	-0.533** (0.264)	-0.279*** (0.094)
Observations	1905	1905	1905
Adj. R-squared	0.104	0.102	0.107

Notes: Results from OLS models. Three damage specifications: self-reported (Self-reported), FEMA tract damage share (Continuous), and above-median FEMA damage (Above median; median among damaged tracts). All specifications include individual controls (party ID, age, education, race, income, evacuation, years in town, home ownership, and insurance), ZIP-code fixed effects, and six tract-level controls (median household income, % renter, % foreign-born, population density, % below poverty, % moved in the past year). Survey weights included. Standard errors clustered at the census-tract level. *** $p < 0.01$; ** $p < 0.05$; * $p < 0.1$

A6 Policy conjoint

Table A13 reports the policy conjoint estimates for both the full sample and the Houston-only subsample (ZIP codes beginning with 77). In the conjoint analyses, both the diversity moderator and the contextual covariates are merged onto respondents' ZIP codes, matching each ZIP to the corresponding ZIP Code Tabulation Area (ZCTA)—the U.S. Census areal approximation of a ZIP code. The 2020 (Wave 3) survey collected respondents' ZIP codes rather than street addresses, so tract-level matches (used in the observational analyses, Tables 1–3) were unavailable. Diversity is constructed as the ethnic fractionalization index applied to ACS 2014–2018 five-year race counts aggregated within each ZCTA (the most recent estimates available when Wave 3 was fielded); the same Herfindahl-style formula used for the observational tract-level measure is applied at this coarser ZIP scale. We refer to these as ZIP-code measures throughout the body of the paper. All specifications include ZIP-code ACS 2015 covariates: median household income, % renter-occupied, % foreign-born, and % below poverty.

Table A13: Policy conjoint: affected $\times$ high tax and high diversity $\times$ high tax, by sample.

	Affected $\times$ Tax (full)		Affected $\times$ Tax (Houston)		HighDiv $\times$ Tax (full)		HighDiv $\times$ Tax (Houston)	
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)
	Baseline	+ ZCTA	Baseline	+ ZCTA	Baseline	+ ZCTA	Baseline	+ ZCTA
High tax in pair=1	-23.860*** (1.484)	-24.147*** (1.486)	-23.135*** (1.529)	-23.308*** (1.530)	-11.084*** (2.581)	-11.085*** (2.581)	-10.530*** (2.888)	-10.530*** (2.888)
Affected by Harvey=1 $\times$ High tax in pair=1	7.825*** (2.283)	8.002*** (2.284)	3.982 (2.423)	4.155* (2.423)				
Affected by Harvey=1	-6.231** (2.936)	-6.195** (2.940)	-1.853 (3.142)	-1.829 (3.147)				
ZCTA median HH income (10k USD)		-0.140 (0.355)		-0.148 (0.381)		-0.206 (0.622)		-0.238 (0.702)
ZCTA % renter		0.628 (4.268)		0.709 (4.553)		-0.144 (6.747)		-0.039 (7.439)
ZCTA % foreign-born		-1.645 (5.992)		-1.365 (6.628)		-1.631 (9.804)		-3.519 (11.302)
ZCTA % poverty		-3.869 (12.246)		-4.246 (13.036)		-3.181 (20.894)		-3.055 (23.551)
High diversity ($\geq$ sample mean)=1 $\times$ High tax in pair=1					-9.426*** (3.553)	-9.425*** (3.553)	-15.140*** (3.847)	-15.139*** (3.847)
High diversity ($\geq$ sample mean)=1					-0.222 (4.579)	-0.167 (4.672)	-1.133 (5.022)	-1.097 (5.131)
Observations	7138	7122	6392	6386	3012	3012	2548	2548

Notes: Linear probability mixed model. Coefficients on the 0–100 choice probability scale. “Full” includes all Wave 3 respondents satisfying the estimation requirements; “Houston” restricts to ZIP codes beginning with 77. Columns (5)–(8) additionally restrict to respondents affected by Harvey, per Equation 5. Dollar-rank ties (pairs where both profiles fall in the same dollar-equivalent tax bracket) are dropped in all columns. Columns labeled “+ ZCTA” add ZIP-code ACS 2015 controls (median household income, % renter, % foreign-born, % below poverty).

Table A14 adds respondent party identification to Equation 5, first as a control and then interacted with the tax attribute, so that each party group has its own tax aversion. Table A15 re-estimates the interaction separately on pairs that compare two options with the same tax base, or a tax with no tax, and on pairs that compare a property tax with a sales tax.

Table A14: Policy conjoint: the diversity–tax interaction and respondent partisanship.

	(1)	(2)	(3)
	Baseline	+ Party ID	+ Party ID $\times$ Tax
Higher diversity $\times$ High tax	-15.139*** (3.847)	-15.142*** (3.847)	-15.214*** (3.855)
Observations	2548	2548	2548

Notes: Linear probability mixed model of Equation 5, Houston-only affected respondents, with ZIP-code ACS 2015 controls. Column (2) adds respondent party identification; column (3) adds its interaction with the high-tax indicator. Only the focal coefficient is reported. Standard errors in parentheses. *** $p < 0.01$; ** $p < 0.05$; * $p < 0.1$

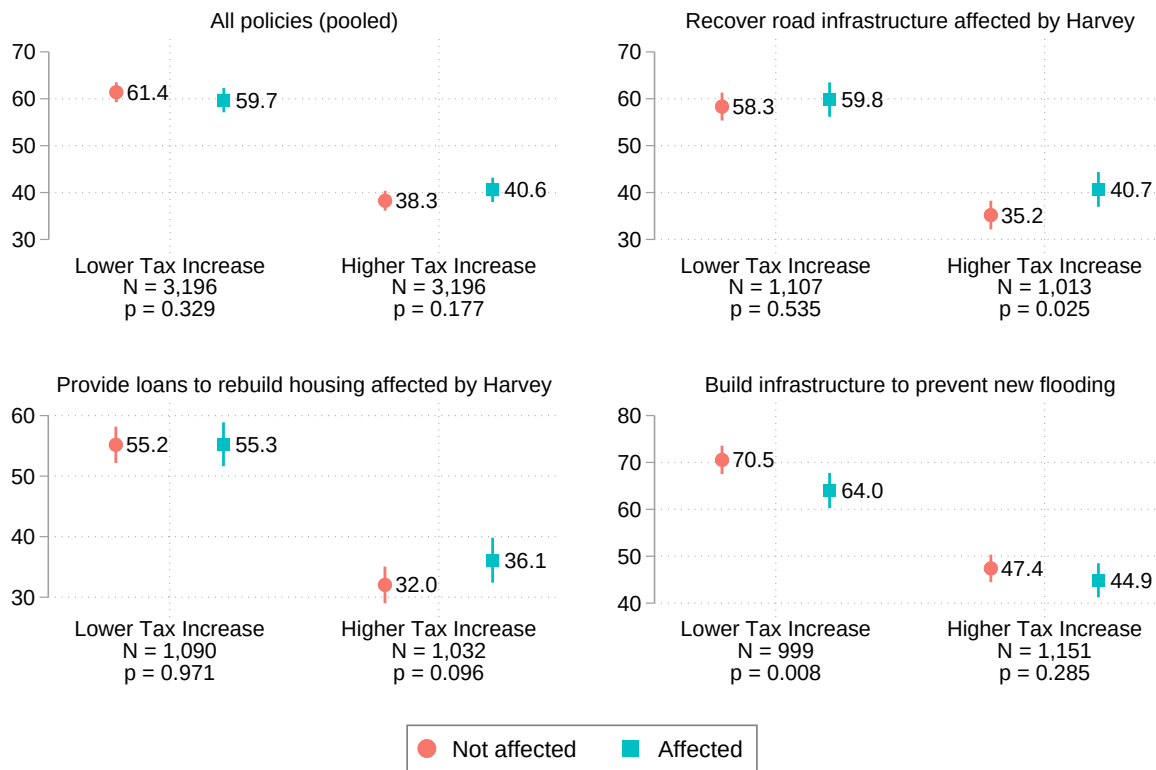
Table A15: Policy conjoint: the diversity–tax interaction by tax-base composition of the pair.

	All pairs (1)	Excluding cross-base (2)	Cross-base only (3)
Higher diversity × High tax	-15.139 (3.847) $p < 0.001$	-11.278 (4.727) $p = 0.017$	-20.857 (6.643) $p = 0.002$
Profile evaluations	2,548	1,678	870
Difference (3) – (2)	-9.579 (SE 8.153), $p = 0.240$		
MDE at 80% power, column (1)	10.8 pp		

Notes: Linear probability mixed model of Equation 5, Houston-only affected respondents, with ZIP-code ACS 2015 controls. Each tax option displayed its annual dollar cost; the three property-tax and three sales-tax levels carry the same amounts (\$200, \$400, \$600). The difference row treats columns (2) and (3) as independent samples, an approximation that ignores that the same respondents contribute pairs of both types. MDE is the minimum detectable effect at 80% power and a two-sided 5% test.

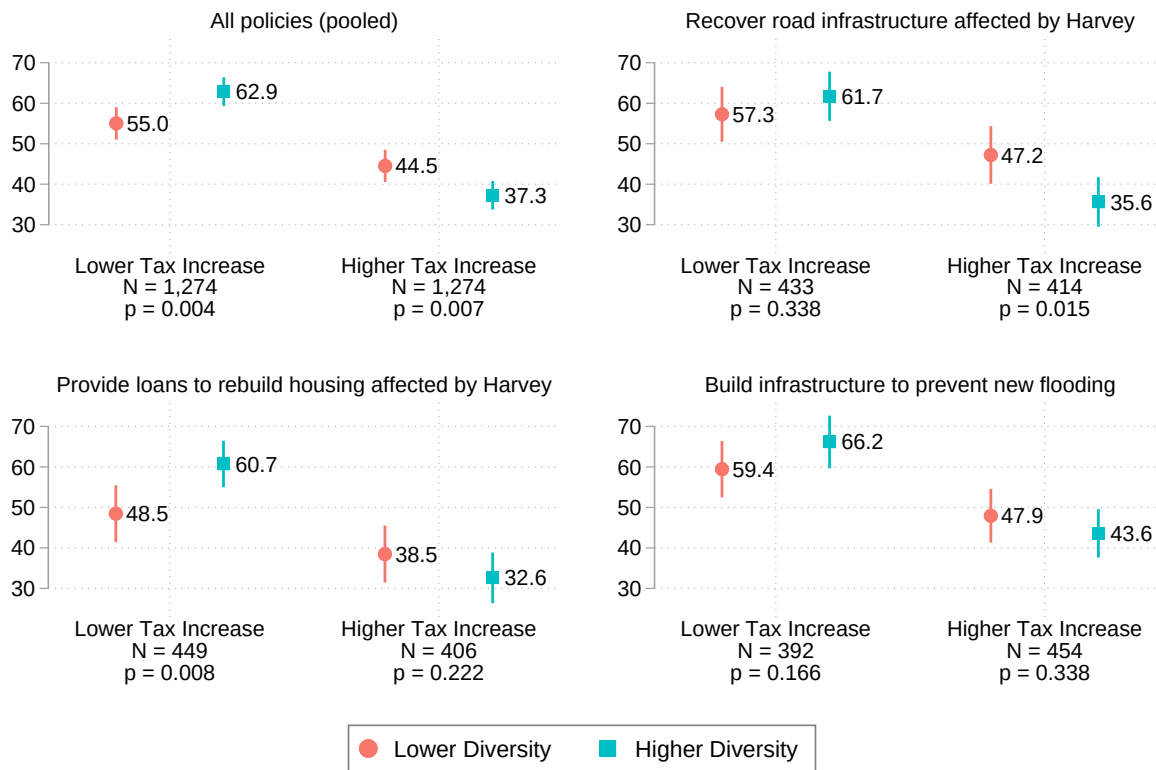
Figures A3 and A4 reproduce the policy conjoint with the full per-policy decomposition. The top-left panel of each figure (pooled across policy types) is reproduced in the main text as Figure 4 and Figure 5 respectively. The remaining three panels disaggregate the predicted margins by policy domain (road recovery, housing loans, flood prevention).

Figure A3: Predicted margins of choosing high versus low tax increases following Hurricane Harvey conditional on being affected by the storm, by policy type.



Notes: Points plot predicted margins of choosing the proposed policy option for respondents affected by Hurricane Harvey (teal squares) and not affected (salmon circles), conditional on (i) the size of the required tax increase (lower vs. higher) and (ii) how the additional revenue would be used. The top-left panel pools all policy earmarks. The top-right panel shows results for recovering damaged road infrastructure, the bottom-left panel for providing loans to rebuild housing affected by Harvey, and the bottom-right panel for building infrastructure to prevent future flooding. Labels below each tax condition report the number of profile evaluations (N) and the p-value for the affected–unaffected difference at that tax level. Vertical bars denote 95% confidence intervals. Houston-only Wave 3 sample.

Figure A4: Predicted margins of choosing high versus low tax increases following Hurricane Harvey for affected respondents conditional on ethnic diversity, by policy type.



Notes: Points plot predicted margins of choosing the proposed policy option for respondents living in lower-diversity areas (below-mean ethnic diversity, salmon circles) and higher-diversity areas (above-mean, teal squares), conditional on (i) the size of the required tax increase (lower vs. higher) and (ii) how the additional revenue would be used. The top-left panel pools all policy earmarks, the top-right panel shows results for recovering road infrastructure damaged by Hurricane Harvey, the bottom-left panel for providing loans to rebuild housing affected by Harvey, and the bottom-right panel for building infrastructure to prevent future flooding. Labels beneath each tax condition report the number of profile evaluations (N) and the p-value for the higher-lower diversity difference at that tax level. Vertical bars denote 95% confidence intervals. Houston-only Wave 3 sample, affected respondents only.

A6.1 The tax-diversity penalty by project type

Table A16 splits the policy conjoint by project type: flood-prevention infrastructure is the forward-looking category, road recovery and housing loans the backward-looking ones, and the rows report the tax-diversity penalty within each group. A time-horizon account predicts the penalty con-

concentrates on the mitigation profiles. The point estimate is instead larger on the response profiles, although the response–mitigation difference is not statistically significant ($p = 0.48$); there is no evidence that the penalty concentrates on the mitigation profiles.

Table A16: Policy conjoint: the tax–diversity penalty by project type.

	Coef.	Std. error	z	p
Mitigation $\times$ High tax $\times$ Higher diversity (Houston, affected)	5.746	8.167	0.70	0.482
Mitigation $\times$ High tax $\times$ Higher diversity (full sample, affected)	8.271	7.533	1.10	0.272
High tax $\times$ Higher diversity, response profiles	-16.842	4.720	-3.57	<0.001
High tax $\times$ Higher diversity, mitigation profiles	-11.097	6.665	-1.66	0.096

Notes: Linear probability mixed model of Equation 5 with the project attribute recoded as mitigation (flood-prevention infrastructure) versus response (road recovery, housing loans) and fully interacted with the high-tax and higher-diversity indicators; Houston-only affected respondents except where the row indicates the full sample. The two within-group rows are linear combinations of the interaction terms.

A7 Partner-choice conjoint

The partner-choice conjoint, implemented in the 2020 (Wave 3) survey, presented respondents with paired hypothetical individuals and asked which they would prefer to collaborate with in a neighborhood association formed for future flooding. Each profile randomizes five attributes: race/ethnicity (White, Black, Hispanic), gender (male, female), party identification (Democrat, Republican, Independent), religion (Christian/Protestant, Roman Catholic, nonreligious, Muslim, Jewish), and civic-association membership (ASPCA, MADD, NRA, Rotary International, YMCA); race and gender are conveyed through a photograph and first name aligned with each race–gender combination. Race and gender are the only attributes presented visually, via the photographs; all other attributes are shown as text. Each race–gender combination is represented by a single photograph and first name, so estimates of race and gender ingroup effects reflect responses to these specific exemplars as well as to the broader social categories.

Figure A5 displays the six profile images used in the partner-choice conjoint. Each image represents a unique combination of race and gender, which were the only attributes presented visually; all other attributes were presented as text.

Figure A5: Artificially generated profile images used in the partner-choice conjoint. The images do not depict real individuals. Race and gender are the only attributes presented via images; all other attributes are shown as text.



miguel



darnell



guadalupe



julie



latonya



matthew

Respondents were presented with the following vignette:

Now, let's suppose that you are creating a neighborhood association to provide information and help to people in the neighborhood during future flooding. Which of these two individuals do you prefer to collaborate with?

Figure A6: Example of paired-choice task in the partner-choice experiment. Artificially generated profile images. The images do not depict real individuals. Race and gender are the only attributes presented via images; all other attributes are shown as text.



Notes: See Figure A5 for the full set of race–gender profiles.

Cases in which the respondent and the profile share the same value on a given attribute are coded as “ingroup.” For each respondent i , task t , and profile p , we recode five binary indicators that equal 1 when the profile matches the respondent’s self-report and 0 otherwise: M_{itp}^{gender} (ingroup gender), M_{itp}^{race} (ingroup race), M_{itp}^{party} (ingroup party), M_{itp}^{relig} (ingroup religion), and M_{itp}^{assoc} (ingroup association). “Independent” and “Non-religious” are treated as valid ingroups. Respondents whose reported race is not among the three profile categories (those selecting American Indian or Alaska Native, Asian/Pacific Islander, or Other) receive $M_{itp}^{\text{race}} = 0$ for all profiles; the three respondents who did not report their gender as male or female are excluded from estimation because the gender cue is undefined for them. We classify each respondent’s ZIP code as lower-diversity if the diversity index is below the sample mean and as higher-diversity if it is above the sample mean. Let $g_i \in \{\text{Lower Diversity}, \text{Higher Diversity}\}$ denote this status (constant across

tasks for respondent i). We estimate the following equation separately for $g_i = \text{Lower Diversity}$ and $g_i = \text{Higher Diversity}$:

$$\text{Cooperation}_{itp} = \alpha + b_1 M_{itp}^{\text{gender}} + b_2 M_{itp}^{\text{race}} + b_3 M_{itp}^{\text{party}} + b_4 M_{itp}^{\text{relig}} + b_5 M_{itp}^{\text{assoc}} + \varepsilon_{itp} \quad (\text{A1})$$

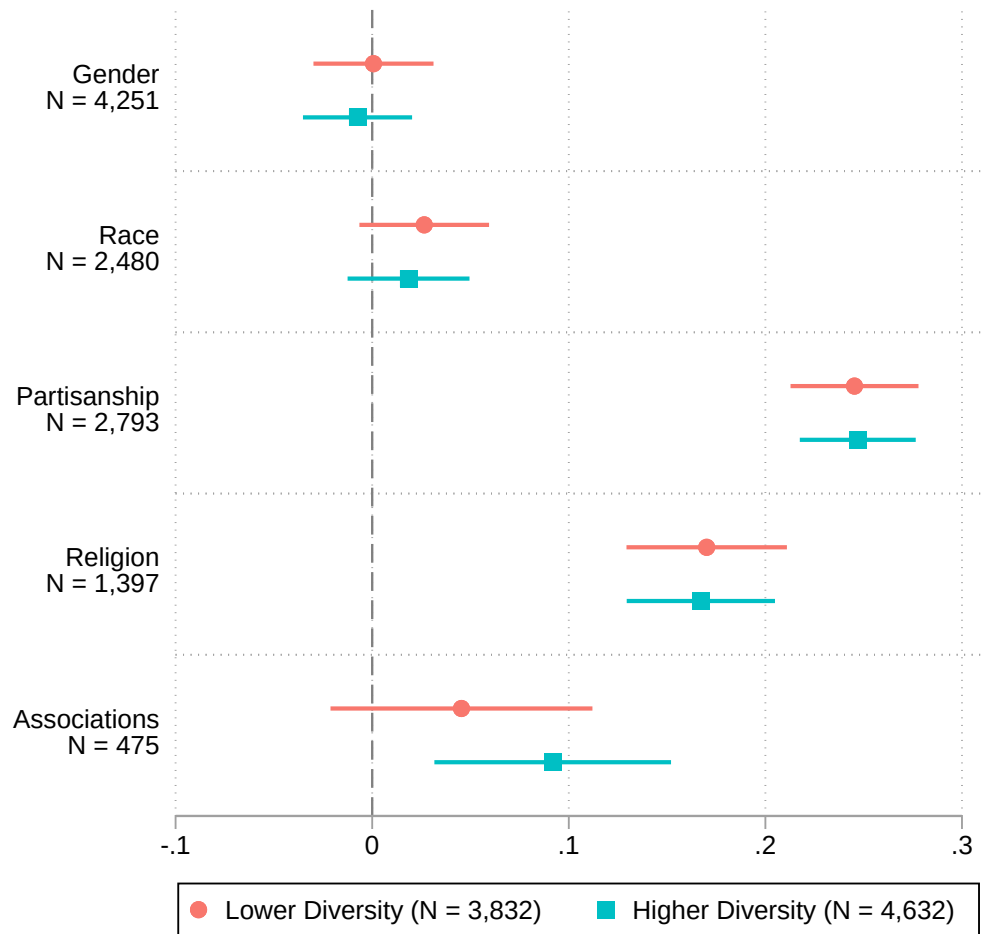
if diversity = g_i .

We compare b_1 – b_5 across $g_i = \text{Lower Diversity}$ versus $g_i = \text{Higher Diversity}$ to assess how cooperation patterns vary with neighborhood diversity. The results show three patterns. First, respondents are more likely to cooperate with hypothetical profiles sharing the same religion (17 pp) or partisan affiliation (25 pp). These effects are stable across levels of diversity. Second, and notably, effects are indistinguishable from zero for gender and race, suggesting that ascriptive traits appear to be less important drivers of cooperation. Finally, civic associations display a different pattern: they show no detectable effect in lower-diversity areas, but become relevant drivers of cooperation in higher-diversity areas. The average marginal component effect of shared civic-association membership rises from 4.5 pp (not significant) in lower-diversity ZIP codes to 9.2 pp ($p < 0.01$) in higher-diversity ZIP codes.

Consistent with our monitoring argument, in diverse environments, ascriptive traits are not inherently informative signals for identifying reliable cooperation partners. They drive cooperation only insofar as they carry informational value about expected reciprocity and sanctioning capacity. In our setting, race and gender appear to carry little such informational value even in areas with below-mean levels of diversity. In higher-diversity settings, shared membership in a civic association becomes a more informative signal. This interpretation is consistent with experimental evidence showing that ascriptive traits do not automatically boost cooperation, but matter insofar as they convey information about expected reciprocity, trust, and sanctioning capacity (Burns and

Keswell, 2015). It also complements qualitative research on civic associations in disaster recovery, which emphasizes their role in information transmission and coordination in heterogeneous communities (Storr and Haeffele-Balch, 2012).

Figure A7: Probability of cooperating with ingroup profiles.



Notes: Average marginal component effects of each ingroup cue on cooperation probability. Salmon circles: respondents in lower-diversity ZIP codes (below-mean ethnic diversity). Teal squares: respondents in higher-diversity ZIP codes (above-mean ethnic diversity). Horizontal bars denote 95% confidence intervals; the vertical line at zero marks a null effect. Labels on the left report the number of profile evaluations in which each ingroup cue is present (*N*); the legend reports the number of profile evaluations in the lower- and higher-diversity subsamples. Wave 3 respondents with a ZIP-code diversity match. Diversity is measured at the ZIP-code level (see Section A7). See Table A17 for the full coefficient table.

Table A17 reports the coefficients underlying Figure A7, estimated separately for respondents in ZIP codes with below-mean (Lower diversity) and above-mean (Higher diversity) ethnic frac-

tionalization. Table A18 pools the two subsamples and interacts each ingroup cue with the higher-diversity indicator. The interaction on the association cue is 0.046 (SE 0.046, $p = 0.31$), and a joint test across the five cues gives $p = 0.93$; the split-sample contrast therefore does not establish that the association cue differs across diversity levels (Gelman and Stern, 2006). Respondents were asked whether they belong to each of the five organizations shown in the profiles (ASPCA, MADD, NRA, Rotary International, and YMCA); membership rates are 12.4 percent for the YMCA, 8.6 for the ASPCA, 4.9 for the NRA, and 4.3 each for MADD and Rotary, 26.9 percent of respondents belong to at least one, and a respondent and a profile share an organization in 5.6 percent of evaluations. Re-estimating the association effect excluding one organization at a time, dropping the NRA reduces the higher-diversity coefficient from 0.092 to 0.043; dropping any other organization leaves it between 0.078 and 0.142.

Table A17: Partner-choice conjoint: ingroup cooperation by neighborhood diversity.

	Lower Diversity		Higher Diversity	
	(1) Orig	(2) + ZCTA	(3) Orig	(4) + ZCTA
Ingroup gender	0.001 (0.016)	0.001 (0.016)	-0.007 (0.014)	-0.007 (0.014)
Ingroup race	0.026 (0.017)	0.027 (0.017)	0.018 (0.016)	0.019 (0.016)
Ingroup party	0.245*** (0.017)	0.246*** (0.017)	0.247*** (0.015)	0.247*** (0.015)
Ingroup religion	0.170*** (0.021)	0.170*** (0.021)	0.167*** (0.019)	0.167*** (0.019)
Ingroup association	0.045 (0.034)	0.045 (0.034)	0.092*** (0.031)	0.092*** (0.031)
ZCTA median HH income (\$10k)		-0.002 (0.004)		0.002 (0.005)
ZCTA % renter		0.027 (0.072)		-0.003 (0.054)
ZCTA % foreign-born		-0.010 (0.100)		0.008 (0.078)
ZCTA % poverty		-0.094 (0.171)		0.087 (0.186)
Observations	3832	3832	4632	4632
Log-likelihood	-2639.661	-2639.445	-3188.450	-3188.322

Notes: Linear probability mixed model with random intercepts at the task and respondent levels, estimated separately for respondents in lower-diversity (below-mean ethnic diversity) and higher-diversity (above-mean ethnic diversity) ZIP codes. Each row reports the average marginal component effect of a given ingroup cue on the probability of choosing that profile. Columns (2) and (4) add ZCTA controls, which barely move the focal estimates. Standard errors in parentheses.

Table A18: Partner-choice conjoint: pooled model with diversity interactions.

	(1)
	Pooled with Diversity interactions
Ingroup gender	0.001 (0.016)
Ingroup race	0.026 (0.017)
Ingroup party	0.245*** (0.017)
Ingroup religion	0.170*** (0.021)
Ingroup association	0.045 (0.034)
High Diversity	0.005 (0.019)
× Ingroup gender	-0.008 (0.021)
× Ingroup race	-0.008 (0.023)
× Ingroup party	0.002 (0.022)
× Ingroup religion	-0.003 (0.028)
× Ingroup association	0.046 (0.046)
Observations	8464
Log-likelihood	-5828.112

Notes: Linear probability mixed model with random intercepts at the task and respondent levels, Wave 3 respondents with a ZIP-code diversity match. Each ingroup cue is interacted with an indicator for above-mean ZIP-code ethnic diversity. Standard errors in parentheses.

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